AI INCOME CHALLENGE VIP: A MEMBER'S PLAYBOOK

# Your First AI Video Ad, Start to Finish

A plain-English guide to making short product ads with Higgsfield: Which ad to start with, what it really costs, prompts you can copy, and how to stay on the right side of the rules.


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Written by a fellow VIP member, October 2026. I research and test Higgsfield video every day for my own project. I haven't sold an ad yet, so everything here is either something I tested myself or comes from a source listed at the end. Prices are Higgsfield's published prices from October 2026; check the Generate button before you spend.

## The Short Version

Businesses already pay for ad videos every month. AI lets one person make them from a single product photo, for a few dollars in credits. The part most people get wrong is **which kind of ad to start with.**

**$100 to $175**
What brands typically pay a human creator for one short UGC video

**$22.50**
Median starting price of the first page of "AI UGC video" gigs on Fiverr

**~$5 to $12**
Credit cost of one 15-second product ad on Higgsfield, with a retry or two

AI actors talking to camera ("AI UGC") are already a crowded, cheap market, and they carry the most legal risk. **Product motion ads** with no people in them (the product in dramatic light, moving, pouring, spinning, landing on the beat) are easier to make well, harder to undercut, and close to risk-free. That's where I'd start, and it's what most of this guide is built around.

One real product photo → a free plan from ChatGPT or Claude → two or three short clips in Higgsfield → text added in a free editor → a 9:16 ad

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## 1 Where the Money Is, Honestly

Ads are a real service with real buyers. The pitch you hear online is usually rosier than the data.

- **The buyers already exist.** Any business running Facebook and Instagram ads needs fresh videos every few weeks, because ads wear out. You can see every one of those businesses for free in the Meta Ad Library (section 9).
- **Human creators set the ceiling.** Brands pay about $100 to $175 for one UGC video from a real person (Pitchlo's 645 briefs: median $100; Influee: median about $175).
- **AI UGC set the floor.** On Fiverr, "AI UGC video" returns 15,000+ gigs, and the first page starts at a median of $22.50. Competing there means competing on price.
- **The monthly model.** Iman's October 28 video pitches $2,000 a month for 12 ads per local business, about $170 an ad. That's his claim, not a measured result, but the shape is right: recurring work beats one-off clips.

**MY TAKE**

Lead with product motion ads. They sit between the $10 gigs and the $1,000+ 3D studios, they don't need an AI person to look real, and they don't run into the fake-testimonial rules. Add AI actors later, as an extra for clients you already have.

## 2 Four Ad Types, Ranked for Beginners

Start at the top of this table and move down only once the first type looks good.

| AD TYPE | WHAT IT IS | CREDITS (ONE TRY) | RISK | WHEN |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1. Product motion** | The real product in dramatic light: macro detail, a pour, a spin, an end card. No people. | **~105 for 15 s** | Low | Start here |
| **2. Static ad pack** | 3 to 5 still ads: feature callout, offer card, lifestyle shot. Runs next to the videos. | **2 to 8 each** | Low | Easy add-on |
| **3. Ad remake** | Take a business's own running ad, keep its facts, make three new versions with new hooks. | **~115 to 135 per ad** | Medium | Once you have a client |
| **4. AI actor (UGC)** | A fictional person shows the product to camera, phone style. | **70 per 10 s (720p)** | High | Later, with care |

Credits from Higgsfield's pricing page (October 2026): Seedance 2.5 is 35 credits per 5 seconds at 720p and 80 at 1080p; a Marketing Studio UGC ad is 70 credits per 10 seconds at 720p and 160 at 1080p. The remake estimate is Iman's. Static image prices come from Higgsfield's UGC guide.

## 3 What One Ad Costs in Credits

Every finished generation is charged, including the ones you throw away. Budget two or three tries per clip.

| PLAN | PRICE | CREDITS A MONTH | PER CREDIT |
|---|---|---|---|
| Starter | $15/month | 200 | **$0.075** |
| Plus | $49/month | 1,000 | **$0.049** |
| Ultra | $129/month | 3,000 | **$0.043** |

### A 15-second product motion ad, worked out

| PIECE | CREDITS | ON PLUS |
|---|---|---|
| 2 or 3 still images to test the lighting | **~1 to 6** | under $0.30 |
| Three 5-second clips at 720p, one try each | **105** | $5.15 |
| Same, with one retry on each clip | **210** | $10.30 |
| Text, logo, music and editing in a free editor | **0** | $0 |

TIP

- Prices differ a lot between video models for the same 5-second clip. Before you commit to one, open a few models and read the credit number on the Generate button. It's free to look.
- Starter doesn't open every video model. Plus and Ultra do. Unused credits don't roll over, and failed generations are usually refunded.

## 4 Your First Ad in One Afternoon

Practice on a product you own before you ever pitch a business. You'll learn more from one finished ad than from ten tutorials.

1. **Pick a product that looks good moving.** Candles, drinkware, coffee, jewelry, skincare packaging, a bag. Things with texture, liquid, light or a satisfying motion.
2. **Take one clean photo.** Plain background, soft window light, the whole product in frame, label facing the camera. Add two close-ups of the details. This photo is your whole ad, so take ten and keep the best.
3. **Plan it for free.** Paste prompt A (section 5) into ChatGPT or Claude with a description of the product. You get the buyer, three ad ideas and a shot list before you spend a credit.

4. **Test the look with stills.** Make two or three still images of the product in different lighting. Images cost almost nothing. Pick the one you'd stop scrolling for.
5. **Make one clip first.** Use your product photo as the start image and prompt B. Check it closely (section 7). Fix the prompt, not the luck: change one thing per try.
6. **Then make the other clips.** Two or three 5-second clips are plenty for a 10 to 15-second ad.
7. **Add the words in an editor, never in the generation.** AI garbles text. Put the product name, the one benefit, the price or offer, and the call to action on top in CapCut or any free editor.
8. **Export 9:16 at 1080 × 1920.** Watch it once with the sound off. If the message doesn't land without sound, the ad isn't done.

**WHAT I LEARNED TESTING HIGGSFIELD VIDEO**

- When you give a start image, describe only the motion. The photo already tells the model what everything looks like.
- Small, slow camera moves look real. Big sweeping moves make the model invent things that weren't in the photo.
- Generate at the resolution you'll deliver. In my tests, upscaling a low-resolution clip afterwards made fine textures like stone and fabric shimmer.
- Test one clip before you queue a batch. One bad prompt times ten clips is an expensive lesson.

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## 5 Copy-Paste Prompts

Swap the [brackets] for your product. Prompt A is free; it runs in any chat AI. The rest go into Higgsfield.

### A. The ad planner (ChatGPT or Claude, free)

```
Act as a performance creative team: strategist, copywriter and video director.
Product: [name, what it is, price, who buys it]
Product page or notes: [paste here]

1. In five bullets: who buys this, why, their main doubt, the single strongest true reason to choose it, and what would make them stop scrolling.
2. Give me three ad concepts that are truly different from each other (different hook, idea and pace), each 10 to 15 seconds, for Instagram Reels at 9:16.
3. For each concept: a shot list of 2 or 3 five-second shots with the one motion in each shot, plus the on-screen text for each moment. The message must work with the sound off.
4. Rules: use only facts I gave you. Never invent prices, reviews, results, discounts or deadlines. No people on screen. Text goes on in editing, not inside the video.
5. Tell me which concept you'd test first and why, in two sentences.
```

### B. One product motion shot (Higgsfield, with your photo as the start image)

```
Slow push-in on the [product] on a [dark stone / soft linen / warm wood] surface. [One motion: a thin ribbon of steam rises from the cup / the candle flame flickers once / water droplets slide down the glass]. Soft studio light from the left, gentle shadows, shallow depth of field. Keep the product's shape, label, colors and proportions exactly as in the photo; only the [steam] moves. Steady camera, no cuts.
```

### C. The 8-beat product motion storyboard

This beat list comes from the free Higgsfield motion skill Iman shared on October 19. Ask for a storyboard of these eight frames as one image first, approve it, and only then make video.

1. Macro tease: an extreme close-up of a detail
2. Hero reveal: the full product in the chosen light
3. Physics moment: the motion that suits this product
4. Feature macro: texture, material or mechanism
5. Second physics moment: bigger and faster
6. Settle: a satisfying return to rest
7. In context: in hand, worn, or on a real surface
8. End card: product, logo and one short line

### D. A static ad pack (Higgsfield's own example, from its free prompt pack)

```
Follow the attached ad workflow for my product. Research customer reviews, competitors, buyer needs and objections, then make 5 static ads for this [$80 leather bag]. It's designed for [work, the gym, and travel].
```

### E. The ad remake (once you have a client)

```
Here is a screen recording of [business]'s current ad. First, list every fact in it: what they sell, the offer and its conditions, location, contact details, claims and the action it asks for. Mark anything you're unsure of instead of guessing. Then write three new ads that ask for the same action, each with a different hook and style, about 15 to 30 seconds each, readable with the sound off. Use only the facts you listed. The business name, prices, phone number and call to action go on as text in editing, never inside the generated video. Show me the plan and a credit estimate before generating anything.
```

The remake idea is Iman's "Method 2" from his October 28 video, where he shares a longer version of this prompt. The one above is my shorter, beginner version.

## 6 Hooks That Stop the Scroll

You get about two seconds. Something must already be happening in the first frame, and one idea is enough for the whole ad.

| HOOK | WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE |
|---|---|
| **The macro mystery** | Open so close on a texture that it's a puzzle, then pull back to reveal the product. |
| **The drop** | The product falls into frame and lands exactly on the first beat of the music. |
| **The pour** | Liquid, sand, light or petals pour over or into the product in slow motion. |
| **The one-line promise** | Big text over the hero shot: "One bag. Work, gym, travel." Facts only. |
| **The question** | "Still lighting candles that tunnel?" Only if the product truly solves it. |
| **The scale surprise** | Start tiny in a big empty space, then cut close so it fills the frame. |
| **The color run** | The same product cycles through every color it comes in, one per beat. |
| **Hands only** | A pair of hands opens, pours, clicks or wears it. No face, so no fake person to explain. |
| **The end first** | Show the finished, satisfying moment, then rewind to how it got there. |
| **The quiet luxury** | No text for two seconds, just one slow shot in beautiful light. Confident brands love this. |

**THREE RULES FOR EVERY AD**

- One benefit per ad. Show it rather than claim it.
- Readable with the sound off. Most people watch muted.
- A soft call to action at the end, with time to read it: "Shop the collection", "Book this week", "Link below".

## 7 The Check Before You Send Anything

Watch every clip at full size next to the original product photo. This is the step that separates a $20 gig from a $150 one.

- ✓ The product's shape, color and label match the photo in every frame. Product drift is the most common failure.
- ✓ No garbled text anywhere in the scene. If a label melts, cut that moment or cover it with your own text.
- ✓ No extra fingers, warped hands, or objects that appear from nowhere.
- ✓ The motion is smooth: no stutter, no sudden jump at the end of the clip. Trim the last half second if needed.
- ✓ Text sits inside the safe zone. On 9:16 Reels ads, the common guidance is to keep about the top 14%, the bottom 35% and 6% on each side clear, because the app's buttons cover them.
- ✓ Every claim on screen is true and confirmed by the business.
- ✓ It works muted, and the call to action is on screen for at least two seconds.

## 8 Rules That Keep You Out of Trouble

Most AI ad tutorials skip this part. It matters more as soon as you're paid to make ads for someone else.

- **No fake reviews or testimonials.** The FTC's rule, in force since October 21, 2024, bans fake reviews and testimonials, AI-generated ones included, with civil penalties.
- **AI people can't claim experience.** Under the FTC's Endorsement Guides, a virtual person counts as an endorser who has never used the product. So an AI actor can show the product, but never say "I've been using this for a week."
- **Label AI ads.** Meta adds "AI info" labels to ads made or heavily edited with AI, and a label next to "Sponsored" for realistic AI people. TikTok asks advertisers to tick "This ad contains AI-generated content".
- **No invented details.** No made-up customer names, star ratings, "verified buyer" captions, prices, discounts or deadlines. Generic footage must never pose as the business's real staff, work or customers.
- **Remake the client's own ad, not a competitor's.** Look at competitors for patterns, never copy their layout, script or footage.
- **Rights.** Use only photos, logos and music the client owns or has a licence for, and fictional adults only.

**A NOTE TO SEND WITH EVERY AI-ACTOR AD**

```
These are AI-generated ads, not customer reviews. The person on screen is an AI actor, so please don't post or run these videos as real testimonials: no "verified buyer" captions, names or star ratings. Turn on the platform's AI label when you publish, and keep every claim true for the real product.
```

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## 9 Finding Your First Client

The best leads are businesses that already pay for ads. They don't need convincing that ads matter, only that yours are better.

1. Open the Meta Ad Library. No account needed. Set the country you work in and the category to "All ads".
2. Search a niche word in quotes, like **"soy candle"** or **"med spa"**, and filter to active ads.
3. Look for small brands with one to three ads that have run for weeks. Old, tired creative is the opening.
4. Open their website for the product photos and a contact email. Shopify's terms ask stores to post one.
5. Make a free 5-second motion clip of their bestseller from their own photo. Send it as a link, "yours to use either way".
6. Offer a small monthly package once they reply. Recurring work is where this adds up.

```
Hi [name], I saw your [product] ad on Instagram and made a short motion version from your product photo, just to show a different angle: [link]. It's yours to use either way. If fresh ads each month would help, I'm happy to send a few options.
```

Cold emails in the US fall under CAN-SPAM: an honest subject line, a real postal address and a working way to opt out.

## 10 Pricing Math and Where I'm Going With This

Know your cost per ad before you quote a price. Then the price is a business decision, not a guess.

| YOUR NUMBERS | EXAMPLE |
|---|---|
| Credits per finished ad, retries included | **~210** |
| Cost per credit on your plan | **$0.049 (Plus)** |
| Credit cost per ad | **~$10** |
| Your hours per ad (planning, checking, editing) | **1 to 2** |
| What the market pays (human UGC / AI UGC gigs) | **$100 to $175 / from $22.50** |

At those numbers, a $150 product motion ad costs about $10 in credits. Where you land between the Fiverr floor and the human-creator ceiling depends on how good your ads look and how easy you are to work with, which is why section 7 matters so much.

### Where I'm going with this

I'm leaning into Higgsfield. My own project is real estate: turning listing photos into smooth walkthrough videos for agents. Ads aren't my main focus, but the skills are the same ones I use every day. Animate a real photo without changing it, keep every word honest, and watch every credit.

So I took everything I'd researched on the ads side and turned it into the guide I wish I'd had on day one. If you build on it, I'd love to see your first ad.

## Sources and Links

| WHAT | WHERE |
|---|---|
| Higgsfield plans and credit prices | higgsfield.ai/blog/higgsfield-pricing-explained |
| Iman, "How To Make $10,000/Month With Higgsfield" (Oct 28) | youtube.com/watch?v=vOBKA8n15vg |
| Human UGC prices (Pitchlo briefs, Collabstr) | knowlify.com/articles/how-much-does-ugc-cost |
| Human UGC prices (Influee) | influee.co/blog/ugc-price |
| Fiverr "AI UGC video" search (checked Oct 27) | fiverr.com/search/gigs?query=ai ugc video |
| FTC rule banning fake reviews | ftc.gov (Aug 2024 press release) |
| FTC Endorsement Guides and virtual influencers | bakerlaw.com summary |
| Meta AI labels on ads | about.fb.com (Feb 2025) |
| TikTok AI-generated content disclosure | ads.tiktok.com help |
| Reels ad safe zones (third-party guide) | socialync.io safe zone tool |
| Meta Ad Library | facebook.com/ads/library |
| CAN-SPAM guide | ftc.gov CAN-SPAM guide |

Not legal advice. Rules and prices change; check the source before you rely on a number.